

Right and Good Thought, the throne of mightiest Ahura and the Obedience (*sraošəm*) of Mazdah" (*Ys* 28⁵). But there clearly cannot be any approach to a spatial conception of the place where the Wise Lord is throned, when "Obedience to Mazdah" comes as its correlative in the next line. Perhaps the nearest approach to localising the Paradise is in *Ys* 30¹—"the felicity that is with the heavenly lights, which through Right shall be beheld by him that wisely thinks." But we need not stay to show that this involves no more real localising than when we speak of "heaven" as the abode of the blessed. The Later Avesta made more of this when it stereotyped the phrase *anayra raocā*, "the Lights without beginning." Yet there too the commoner terms for heaven and hell are *vahištō* and *acištō aṛhuš*, "the Best," "the Worst Existence." The Gathic names for hell are of the same mintage. It is the House of the Lie (*Druj*), and of Worst Thought, the Home of the Dævas, the Worst Existence, and the like. Remorse is the sharpest of the pangs of hell: whoever went on the downward path,

his own thoughts, along that rugged way,
Pursued, like raging hounds, their father and their prey.

But there are more symbols employed here. Hell is full of darkness, sad voices, stench, foul food, and cold. It would seem that the conception of it sprang from the privations of winter on the steppes during the migration southward, when the preciousness of the house-fire made Âtar the very symbol of all that was best for man. For the Iranian, hell and the demons were always in the north. The idea of darkness is the distinguishing feature of the House